

Tsebelis 1999 RG Notes

Tsebelis, George. “Veto Players and Law Production in Parliamentary Democracies: An Empirical Analysis” [1999].
American Political Science Review 93(3): 591-608.

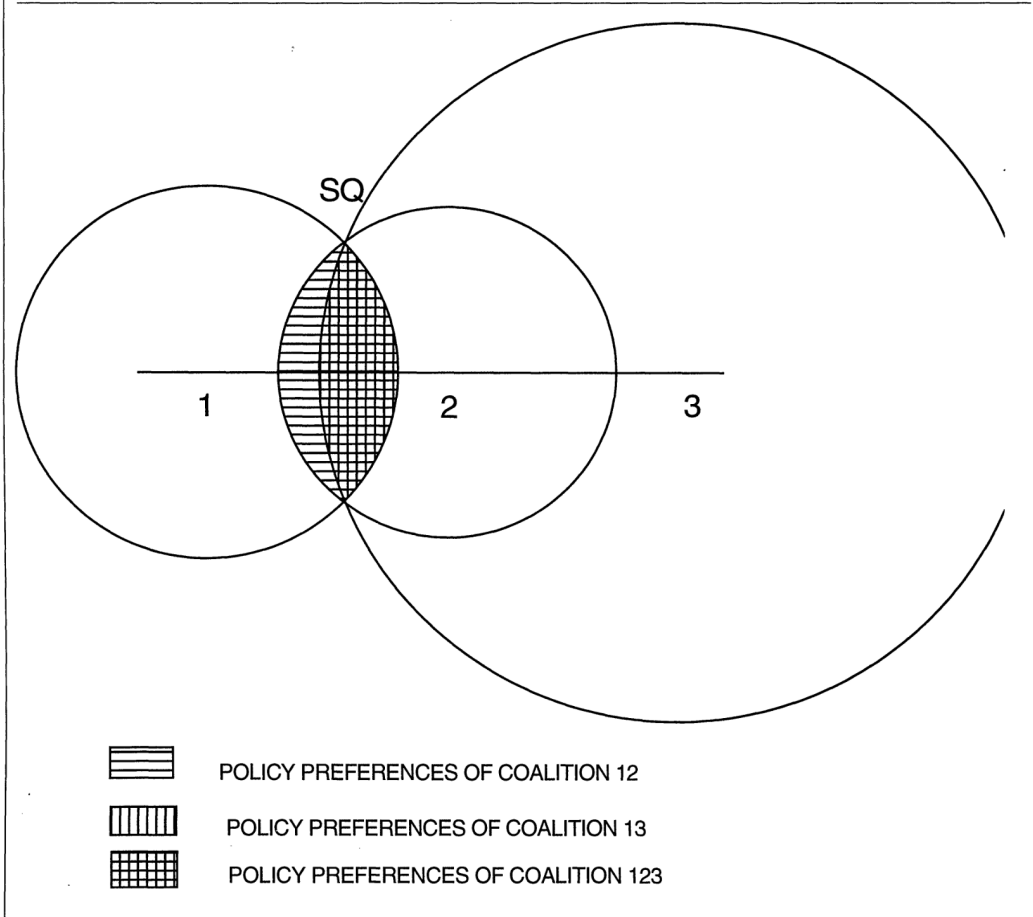
Veto player theory: as the number of veto players – and their ideological incongruence with each other – increases, the legislative capacity of the government/state will decrease. Paper broadly corroborates these hypotheses evaluating workers’ rights proposals in Western Europe in the 1980s.

Second theory on veto players – it should increase pork spending (as you need to satisfy more individuals). Connect to Ferejohn; also look at Alt & Lowry 1994, McCubbins 1991, and Roubinin and Sachs 1989

“PROPOSITION 1: As the number of veto players increases, the winset of the status quo does not increase (i.e., policy stability does not decrease). PROPOSITION 2: As the distance among veto players increases along the same line, the winset of the status quo does not increase (i.e., policy stability does not decrease).” (Tsebelis, 1999, p. 594)

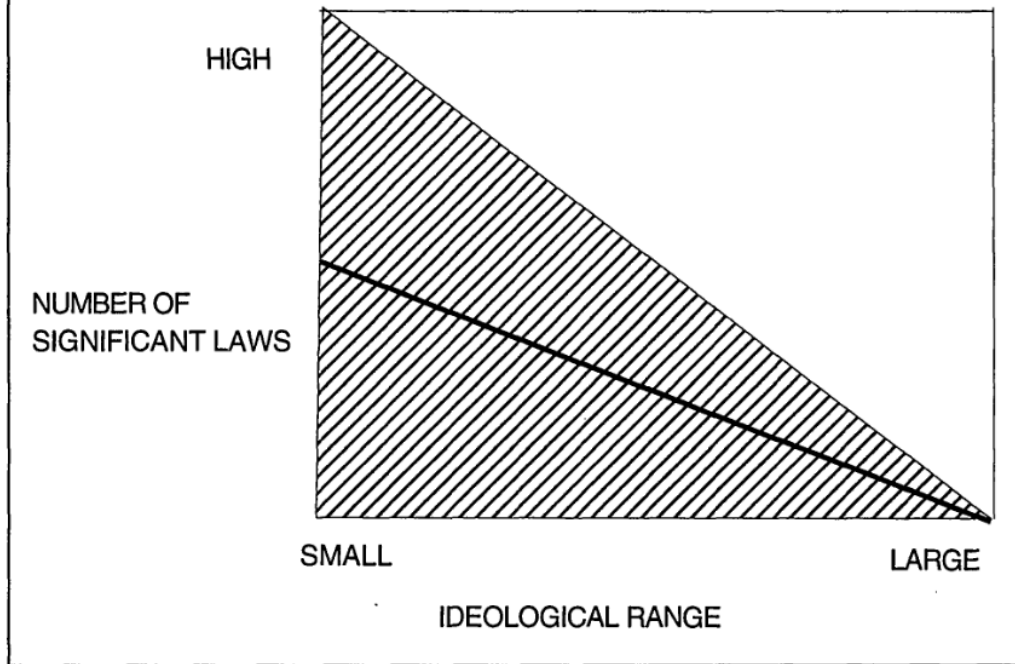
Very much connected to Romer-Rosenthal and status quo reversion – heavy foundation for policy outcomes based on what the current status quo is.

FIGURE 1. Policy Preferences of Coalitions



“COROLLARY (of Propositions 1 and 2): In one dimension, policy stability depends on the maximum ideological distance among vetoplayers, not on their number” (Tsebelis, 1999, p. 595)

FIGURE 2. Expected Area of Significant Laws by Ideological Range of a Coalition



Suggests that general durability of the government (and democracy in general) should be associated with an increase in the number of significant laws

Higher slope of figure 2 – that is, more significant laws under a minute ideological range – for MWC government: the fewer the number of veto players, the more legislative capacity given the alignment of those players